

Central Coast Wine Tour

 **Start:** Santa Barbara

 **End:** Paso Robles

 2 - 3 Days, 8 Stops, 155 Miles

Head north from Santa Barbara to Paso Robles and you'll encounter rolling hills, amazing food, and some of the best wine in the world.

Food & Drink

Arts & Culture

Road Trips

 Created by California Travel Experts

Stop 1: Santa Barbara

735 Anacapa St, Santa Barbara

Perfect architecture, and perfect setting. [Santa Barbara](#), aka “The American Riviera” enjoys a dreamy Mediterranean climate, with plenty of sunny days and mild winters. Add wine country producing, award-winning vintages, outdoor adventures on land and sea, big-city arts and entertainment, and you have a city that’s a poster child for the California good life.

Stroll [State Street](#) for excellent shops and dining, launch a kayak from East Beach to paddle under [Stearns Wharf](#), visit the classic [Old Mission Santa Barbara](#), and tour the 1782 [Presidio](#) for a look at original adobes like El Cuartel, the second-oldest surviving building in the state. Then explore the city’s forward-looking neighborhood—the rehabbed warehouses of [The Funk Zone](#), now home to urban wine-tasting rooms, artists' studios, and cool boutiques.

Planning Resources

- Visit Santa Barbara – <http://www.santabarbaraca.com/>
- Old Mission Santa Barbara - More Information – <http://www.santabarbaramission.org/>
- Stearns Wharf – <http://stearnswharf.org>

- El Presidio de Santa Barbara – http://www.parks.ca.gov/?page_id=608

Stop 2: Buellton

107 W Hwy 246, Buellton

Best known as the gateway to the Santa Ynez Valley, [Buellton](#) has come into its own as a culinary destination. In what was formerly an anonymous industrial area, you can now hang with area winemakers and dig into such favorites as the beef meatballs and ricotta sandwich in the cavernous confines of the restaurant and butcher shop [Industrial Eats](#). A couple doors down, sample the celebrated Pinot Noirs and Chardonnays of pioneering winemaker Richard Sanford in the rustic, modern [Alma Rosa Winery & Vineyards](#) tasting room. And along Highway 246, catch a bit movie history and bite into succulent steaks grilled over oak at the landmark [Hitching Post II](#), the steakhouse that played a starring role in the film *Sideways*.

Planning Resources

- Visit Buellton – <https://discoverbuellton.com/>

Stop 3: Solvang

1683 Copenhagen Dr, Solvang

When it comes to food, most people associate [Solvang](#) with such traditional Danish fare as the *aebleskivers* at longtime favorites like the [Solvang Restaurant](#). But this village of authentic Danish-style architecture is also very much a California wine country town, with numerous [tasting rooms](#). You'll also find a big assortment of California craft beers on tap at [The Good Life Cellar](#), and for farm-to-table dining try [First & Oak](#), which creatively incorporates the seasonal bounty available from local growers.

Planning Resources

- Solvang Conference & Visitors Bureau – <https://www.solvangusa.com>

Stop 4: Santa Ynez

Santa Ynez

Horses and wine share the spotlight in the western-style town of [Santa Ynez](#), where horseshoes honoring local steeds are embedded in a crosswalk and you'll find businesses serving the equestrian community. [Gainey Estate Vineyards & Tasting Room](#) has both indoor and vineyard-surrounded outdoor areas to taste a flight of limited selection estate wines, and [Carr Vineyards & Winery](#) pours varietals produced from grapes grown in the valley and nearby Santa Rita Hills.

Planning Resources

- Santa Ynez Valley Wine Country Association – <http://santaynezwinecountry.com/>

Stop 5: Los Olivos

Los Olivos

The once sleepy ranching town of [Los Olivos](#), where a flagpole stands in the middle of its main street, now has perhaps the Central Coast's highest concentration of tasting rooms. In addition to the must-visit [Los Olivos Tasting Room & Wine Shop](#), you'll also find tasting rooms for such leading Santa Barbara wine producers as [Stolpman Vineyards](#) and [Epiphany](#), where you can sample its Rhone-based varietals in a colorful, contemporary setting or in a shaded garden.

Planning Resources

- Los Olivos – <https://www.losolivosca.com/>

Stop 6: Los Alamos

Los Alamos

Not that long ago, [Los Alamos](#) was a slumbering agricultural community easily overlooked

by travelers racing up and down Highway 101. But food and wine have transformed Los Alamos and now it's a must-stop for tasting rooms and such dining destinations as [Bob's Well Bread Bakery](#). Helmed by a former entertainment executive, the bakery is the place to go for flakey chocolate almond croissants; get there early to score the popular pork-and-beef meatloaf sandwich that frequently sells out. [Full of Life Foods](#) helped pioneer the Los Alamos food scene all the way back in 2003, thanks to such inventive wood-fired creations as a flatbread made with dates, bacon, walnuts, and a smoked leek sauce.

Planning Resources

- Discover Santa Ynez Valley - Los Alamos – <https://www.visitsyv.com/discover-syv/los-alamos/>

Stop 7: Arroyo Grande Valley and Edna Valley

800 A West Branch, Arroyo Grande

With a central village of stalwart stone and brick buildings, as well as its famous swinging bridge, [Arroyo Grande](#) is one of the Central Coast's most appealing small towns. It has also emerged as a wine destination, thanks to a growing collection of tasting room. The town is the gateway to the [SLO Coast AVA](#), the state's newest viticulture area, which contains within it two mostly cool-weather San Luis Obispo County wine regions hidden from U.S. 101: the Arroyo Grande Valley and the Edna Valley. Stop into the low-key, farm-style [Kynsi Winery](#) for its acclaimed Pinot Noirs and Grenaches before taking in the sweeping panorama of vineyards and volcanic peaks from the impressive tasting room at [Chamisal Vineyards](#).

Planning Resources

- SLO Coast Wine – <https://slocoastwine.com/>
- The Village of Arroyo Grande – <https://www.visitarroyogrande.org/play/the-village/>

Stop 8: Paso Robles

1000 Spring St 2nd Floor, Paso Robles

With 40,000 acres of vineyards growing more than 40 grape varieties in 11 distinct regions, the sprawling [Paso Robles wine country](#) is the giant of Central Coast wine regions. From the quaint town square of the city of [Paso Robles](#) to [Epoch Wine Estate](#) in the remote York Mountain AVA, the area is filled with discoveries for wine lovers. For a great one-stop destination just off U.S. 101, [Tin City](#), an industrial-style complex with a collection of boutique wineries, proves that there's more than wine in these parts, thanks to the craft beers at [BarrelHouse Brewing Co.](#) and ciders made from California apples at [Tin City Cider Co.](#)

Planning Resources

- Travel Paso Robles – <http://www.travelpaso.com>